

Guide Proposal

For submission to the How-To Guide platform

Proposed Title

Batch Financial Report Processing for VAs, Part 1: Extraction

What the Guide Teaches

Every VA who's handled a batch of password-protected archives knows the grind: opening them one by one, re-entering the same password, hunting through folders for the right report file, losing track after the twentieth archive. This guide is built directly from that experience — years of doing this by hand — and teaches a VA to set up and run a tool that does it automatically instead: opens a batch of password-protected archives (RAR, ZIP, 7Z, TAR, TAR.GZ, or GZ), finds the target report files inside, and collects them into one folder. What took hours of manual, error-prone repetition now takes minutes.

Outline

- Decision boundaries: what the VA decides versus what needs client sign-off
- Requirements checklist before starting
- One-time computer setup (automatic installer for Python, 7-Zip, and py7zr)
- Step-by-step configuration and running the tool, including choosing the correct archive format
- Troubleshooting common issues (password errors, antivirus warnings, missing files, missing py7zr)
- Appendix covering every file included with the guide
- Closing preview of Part 2: Consolidation, the standalone companion guide that picks up where extraction leaves off

Format

PDF guide (7 pages) plus three supporting files: a one-click setup script, a one-click launcher, and the tool itself. A plain-text Notepad-based install walkthrough is included for VAs who receive the files as pasted text rather than downloads.

Why This Fits the Program's Requirements

- Original: adapted from a production process built from scratch, not copied from any existing source.
- Teaches a repeatable process a VA can run independently once set up.
- Explicitly separates VA-level actions from owner-level decisions throughout, rather than assuming the reader is the business owner.
- Now covers six archive formats instead of one, widening the range of clients a VA can support with the same guide.

Question Before Submission

Before finalizing this submission, I'd like to confirm the terms of sale: is this a non-exclusive purchase, and would I retain the right to reference having created this guide (for example, in a personal portfolio or job application) after it's purchased? Happy to proceed once this is clarified.

Supporting Materials

Updated CV

[Attach current CV here before submitting. Emphasize the production systems background: five years as sole IT resource for a cooperative serving 7,000+ member accounts, direct experience building the ETL/extraction process this guide is based on.]

Video Introduction

[Attach video introduction here before submitting.]